

Paul sends Onesimus home.

Philemon 1-25

Onesimus was in trouble! He had run away. He had taken things with him that weren't his. The things he had taken belonged to Philemon, the man Onesimus had run away from.

One day Onesimus met Paul, a man who loved Jesus. Paul wanted to help Onesimus. Paul told Onesimus about Jesus. Soon Onesimus loved Jesus, too.

Onesimus knew it had been wrong to take things that belonged to Philemon. Onesimus knew he needed to go back to Philemon and say that he was sorry.

Paul wanted to help Onesimus. So he wrote a letter to Philemon. Paul wrote:

Dear Philemon,

I am sending Onesimus, whom I love, back to you.

Please welcome him as you would welcome me.

If he owes you anything, charge it to me.

Your friend, Paul.

Paul gave the letter to Onesimus. Then he said, "You must go back to Philemon. Tell him you are sorry for the wrong things you have done."